



PASSWORD AND ACCOUNT POLICY CONFIGURATION of ADDS LAB

Lab Overview

This lab demonstrated hands-on configuration of Domain Password Policy and Account Lockout Policy on a Windows Server 2022 domain controller using Group Policy Management. Practical experience was gained in setting password complexity requirements, enforcing password history, configuring account lockout thresholds, and managing lockout durations through the Default Domain Policy.

Topics Covered

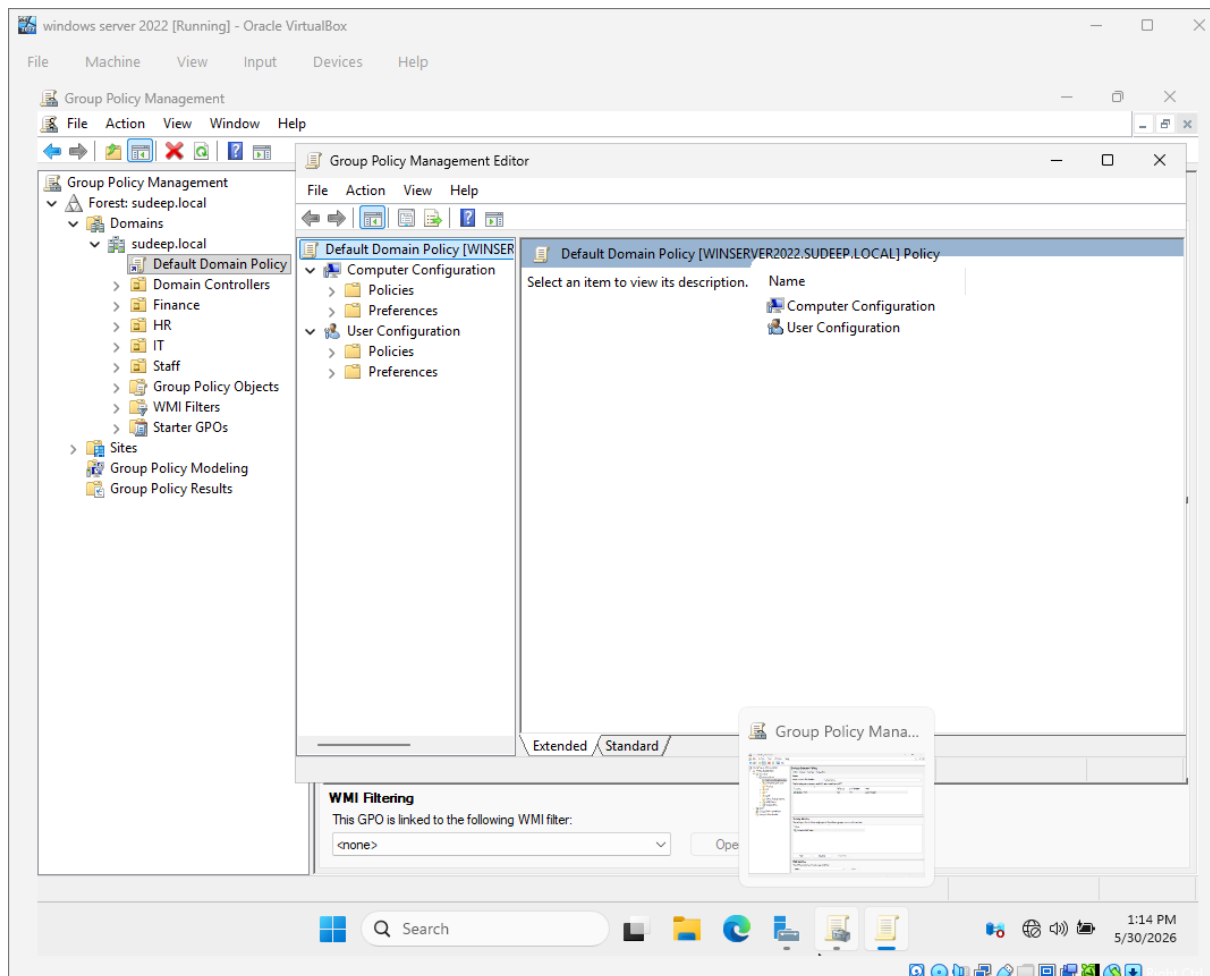
- Domain Password Policy Management
 - Group Policy Management Console (GPMC)
 - Default Domain Policy Configuration
 - Enforce Password History
 - Minimum Password Length
 - Password Complexity Requirements
 - Maximum Password Age
 - Account Lockout Policy Management
 - Account Lockout Threshold Configuration
 - Account Lockout Duration
 - Reset Account Lockout Counter
-

Domain Password Policy Management

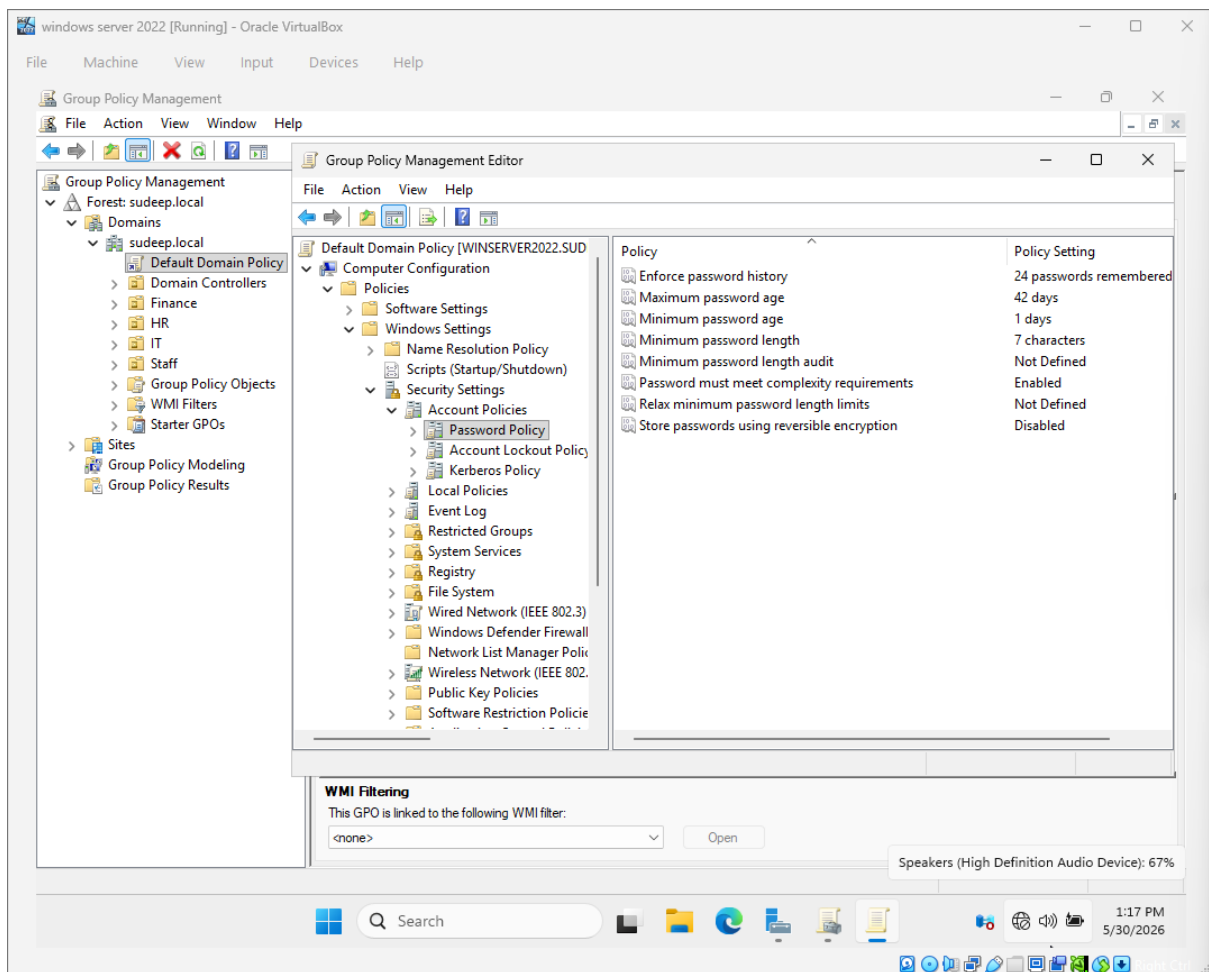
Open Server Manager → Tools → Group Policy Management. Right-click the Default Domain Policy and select Edit, then navigate to:

Computer Configuration → Policies → Windows Settings → Security Settings → Account Policies → Password Policy

Step 1 — Open Group Policy Management



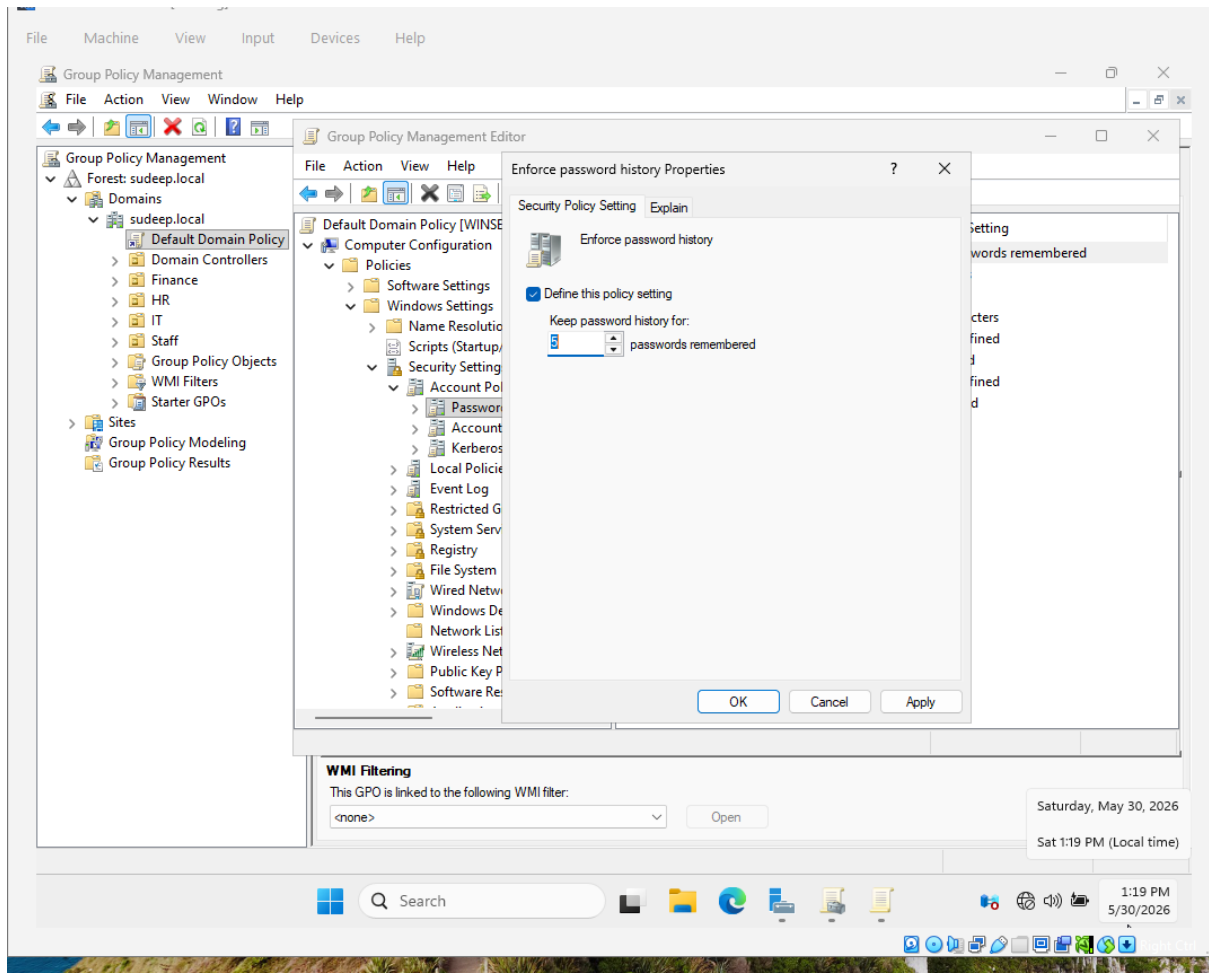
Step 2 — Navigate to Password Policy



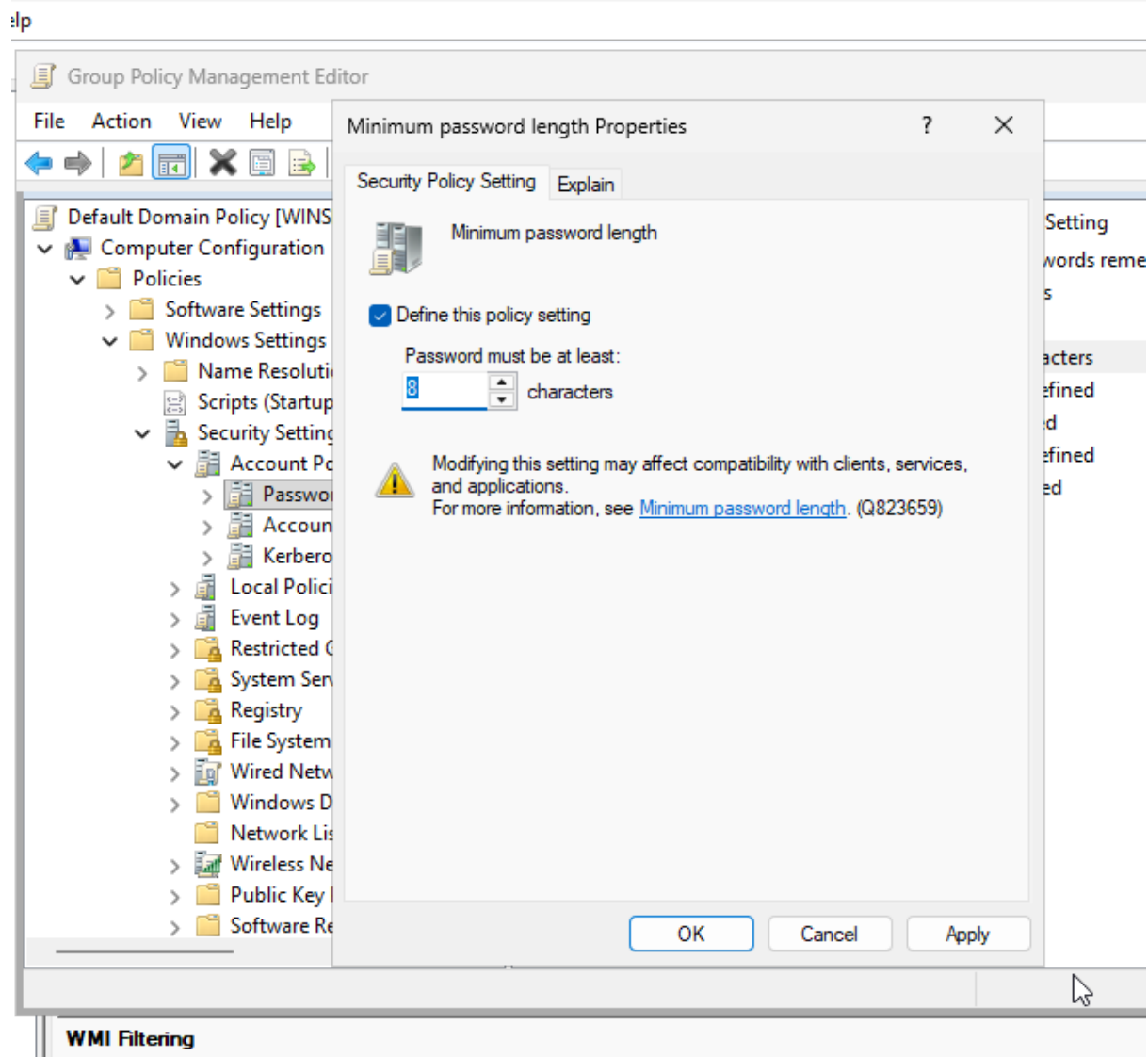
Step 3 — Configure Password Settings

Set the following password policy values:

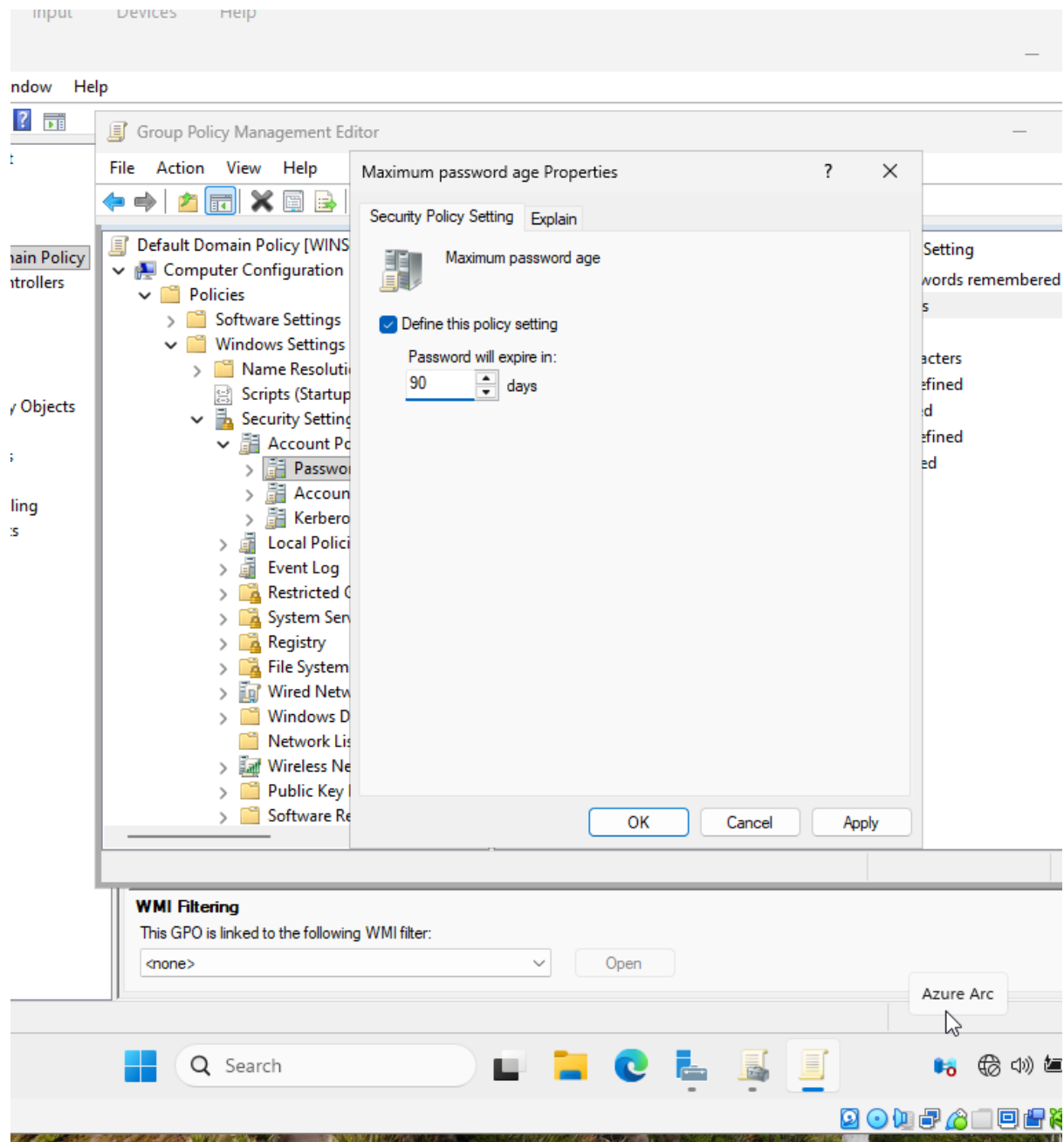
- Enforce Password History = 5
- Minimum Password Length = 8
- Password Complexity = Enabled
- Maximum Password Age = 90 Days



Step 4 — Enforce Password History



Step 5 — Minimum Password Length



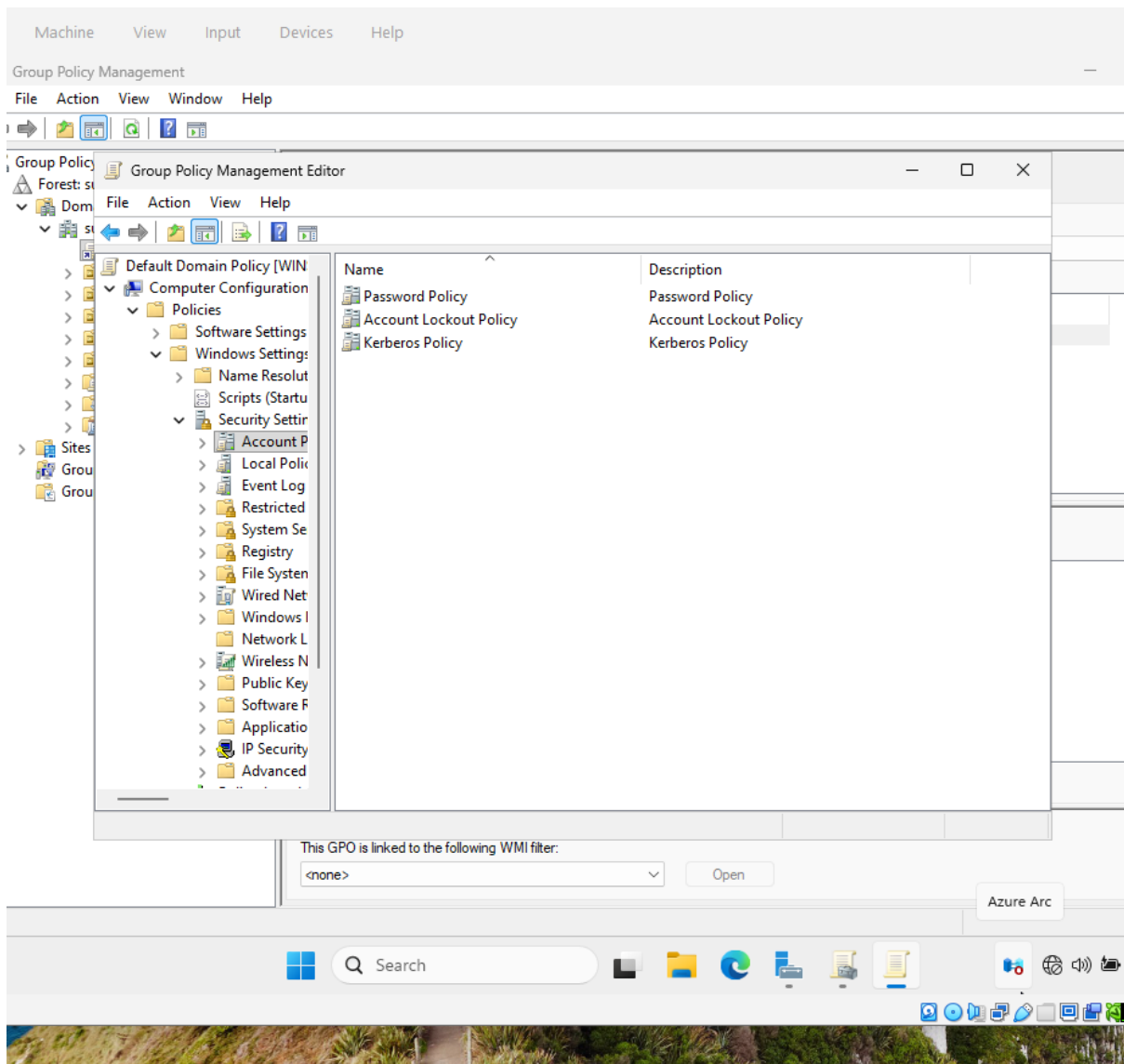
Account Lockout Policy Management

Scenario: If a user enters the wrong password multiple times, the account should lock automatically to prevent brute-force attacks.

Navigate to: Computer Configuration → Policies → Windows Settings → Security Settings → Account Policies → Account Lockout Policy

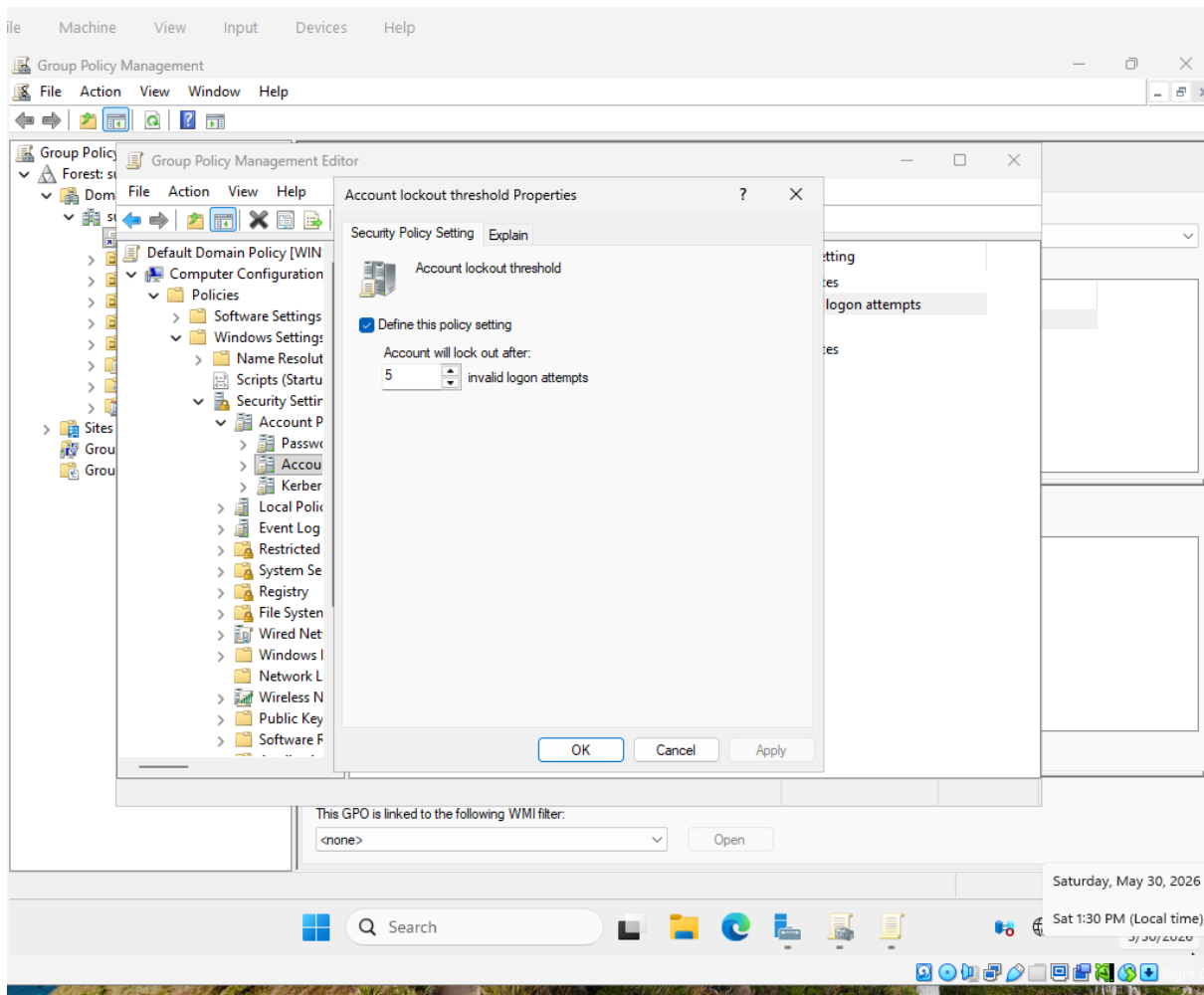
Step 6 — Set Account Lockout Threshold

Set Account Lockout Threshold to 5 invalid attempts.

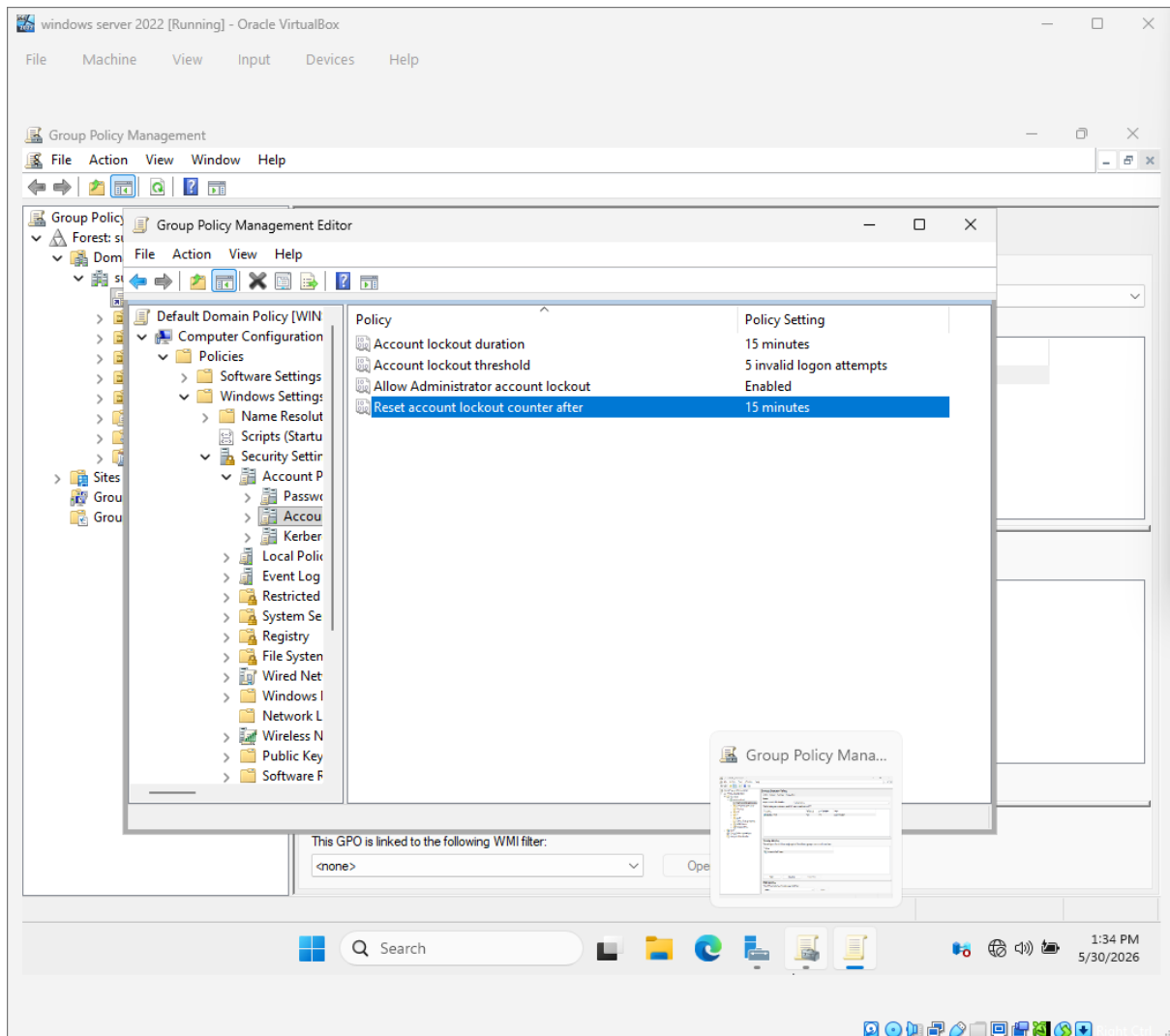


Step 7 — Configure Lockout Duration

Set Account Lockout Duration and Reset Account Lockout Counter After to 15 minutes. Click Apply then OK.



Step 8 — Confirm Policy Applied



Conclusion

This lab demonstrated hands-on configuration of Domain Password and Account Lockout Policies using Group Policy Management on Windows Server 2022. Skills developed include enforcing password complexity, history, and age requirements, as well as configuring lockout thresholds and durations to protect the domain against unauthorized access.

These are foundational Active Directory administration skills directly applicable to IT Help Desk and Junior System Administrator roles.
